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ComEd files to recover \$234M from customers

Reconciling the utility's 2025 cost overruns would raise bills, but other charges are expected to drop

By Robert Channick
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

ComEd filed for a \$234.3 million rate reconciliation Friday, seeking to recover cost overruns the utility incurred in 2025 from customers on their monthly bills next year. But on the brighter side, total electricity

delivery charges are set to go down in 2027 compared to this year.

The utility says the added costs were related to connecting data centers and other new businesses, as well as electrification efforts such as building out EV charging infrastructure in 2025. If approved, the cost reconciliation would add

\$2.97 per month to the distribution charges on the average residential customer bill beginning in January 2027.

The Illinois Commerce Commission is expected to render a decision in December.

The 2025 cost reconciliation will be partially offset by a \$128 million revenue adjustment filed by ComEd in March. The utility "overcollected" from customers based on a higher projected load for 2025

than the actual usage, according to Jason Decker, vice president of regulatory policy at ComEd. If the revenue reconciliation is approved by the ICC, ComEd will also issue a \$0.56 monthly credit embedded in the delivery charges on the average residential customer bill next year, he said.

The net result: the combined reconciliation of actual costs and revenues for 2025 will add \$2.41 per month to the average ComEd

customer bill in 2027, which is \$1.22 per month less than the adjustment added to this year's bills. That means delivery charges should go down for most customers beginning in January.

"Reconciliation proceedings are a valuable means for ensuring that electricity rates are reasonable and aligned with prudently incurred costs," Gil Quiniones, president

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James Hardy casts a fishing rod at the Humboldt Park Lagoon on Saturday in Chicago. A lifelong Chicagoan, Hardy, 67, said he has been fishing the lagoon for 22 years, mostly for catfish and bluegill. **JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS**

Can fish, swan boats co-exist at Humboldt Park Lagoon?

Anglers say the pedaled vessels are making it harder for game fish to thrive



Swan boats are docked at the Humboldt Park Lagoon on Saturday.

By Adriana Pérez
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

During Chicago's bitter winter of 2013-2014, the Humboldt Park Lagoon froze over, and snow piled on top of the thick layer of ice, plunging vegetation into a deadly darkness. This caused a large fish kill, a blow to the ecosystem and the thriving angler community.

"Oh my God, it was terrible," recalled Larry Green, who founded the Humboldt Park Fishing Society in 2010 as he spent more time in the park after being diagnosed with kidney disease. "It killed off all the largemouth bass. The bluegill population was decimated. There were seagulls flying all

over the place, picking up fish."

The group had to do something about it, Green said, so its members began fundraising to restock the lagoon with game fish in 2015 and 2016, efforts he said were widely supported by the community.

Now, the society once again finds itself in a similar position just as fishing season, from spring through October, takes off.

After rebounding from harsh weather and invasive species, members point to population decline, expected after a decade of bass and bluegill fishing, and a new ecosystem threat: the park's fleet of 15 swan boats, which have been a staple since 2018

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Trump says US will 'guide' ships out of strait

He offers few details on plan as Iran mulls proposals to end war

By Adam Schreck,
Melanie Lidman and Cara Anna
ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI, United Arab Emirates — The United States will launch an effort on Monday to "guide" stranded ships from the Iran-gripped Strait of Hormuz, President Donald Trump said, giving few details about a sweeping bid to help hundreds of vessels and 20,000 seafarers.

Amid a three-week ceasefire, Trump said in a social post Sunday that "neutral and innocent" countries have been affected by the Iran war, and "we have told these Countries that we will guide their Ships safely out of these restricted Waterways, so that they can freely and ably get on with their business."

"Project Freedom" would begin Monday morning in the Mideast, Trump said, adding that his representatives are having discussions with Iran that could lead to something "very positive for all."

U.S. Central Command said the initiative would involve guided-missile destroyers, more than 100 aircraft and 15,000 service members. The Pentagon did not immediately answer questions about how they would be deployed.

Iran's effective closure of the strait, imposed after the U.S. and Israel launched the war on Feb. 28, has shaken global markets.

Ships and seafarers, many on oil and gas tankers and cargo ships, have been stuck in the Persian Gulf since the war began. Crew members have described watching intercepted drones and missiles explode over the waters, and running low on drinking water, food and other supplies.

Many sailors come from India and other countries in south and southeast Asia.

"They are victims of circumstance," Trump wrote, and described the effort as a humanitarian gesture "on behalf of the United States, Middle Eastern Countries

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INSIDE

Weak US dollar a double-edged sword

The dollar has fallen about 10% against other major currencies since President Donald Trump returned to office, potentially playing a role in Americans' concerns about affordability. **Nation & World, B1**

ICE quieter, but mission the same

The administration appears to be recalibrating its approach to a policy that helped bring Trump back to the White House, but it is not backing down from its deportation goals. **Nation & World, B2**

Pro-Trump group making some officials see red

Chicago Flips Red members test patience with public testimony, triggering legal tangles

By A.D. Quig
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Cook County Commissioner Tara Stamps declared after a recent meeting that she'd had enough.

Jessica Jackson, a member of the group Chicago Flips Red, had taken to the podium that March morning during public comment in front of the county's Finance Committee. Jackson didn't address any agenda items, instead hitting what for her is a common refrain: that the county had spent too much on immigrants at the expense of other quality of life improvements.

Hours later, Stamps sent a brief email to fellow Commissioner John Daley and two other colleagues, plus Laura Lechowicz Felicione, the general counsel for Board President Toni Preckwinkle.

"I am fed up with how we allow the rampant disrespect to go on in our board meetings! These people are unstable, disrespectful, and completely out of order," she wrote, according to an email obtained through a Tribune open records request. "We are complicit in being disrespected on our jobs. What you all

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Chicago Flips Red founder Zoe Marsh-Leigh speaks, along with other members of the group, during public statements in Chicago City Council chambers in December 2025. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

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